

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL
AWITI



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY
EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS
ALT 110: CRITICAL READING AND RESPONSE

1ST SEMESTER 2022/2023

TIME: 2 HRS

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer question One and any other Two questions

1. "It is only through the stages of critical reading that one can fully appreciate the meaning of a text". With specific examples from texts studied in this course, explain the truthfulness of this statement. (24 marks)
2. Discuss how setting and characterization enable the writer to explore the central theme in any short story you have studied in this course. (22 marks)
3. "In Marjorie Oludhe Macgoye's "Coming to Birth", Paulina and Martin are both symbolic characters. Discuss how the two characters help a critical reader to understand what the author of this text intended to communicate (22 marks)
4. With specific examples, explain the following terms as they are used in critical reading:
 - a) Critical analysis
 - b) Evaluating a text (22 marks)
5. With specific examples, examine the main source of conflict between Lakunle and Sidi in Wole Soyinka's "The Lion and the Jewel." (22 marks)
6. Explicate the following poem by focusing on its form and content (22 marks)

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I Speak for the Bush by Everett Standa

When my friend sees me
He swells and pants like a frog
Because I talk the wisdom of the bush!
He says we from the bush
Do not understand civilized ways
For we tell our women
To keep the hem of their dresses
Below the knee.

We from the bush, my friend insists,
Do not know how to 'enjoy':
When we come to the civilized city,
Like nuns, we stay away from the nightclubs
Where women belong to no men
And men belong to no women
And these civilized people
Quarrel and fight like hungry lions!

But my friend, why do men
With crippled legs, lifeless eyes,
Wooden legs, empty stomachs
Wander about the streets
Of this civilized world?

Teach me, my friend, the trick,
So that my eyes may not
See those whose houses have no walls
But emptiness all around;
Show me the wax that you use
To seal your ears
To stop hearing the cry of the hungry;
Teach me the new wisdom
Which tells men
To talk about money and not love,
When they meet women;

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Tell your God to convert
Me to the faith of the indifferent,
The faith of those
Who will never listen until
They are shaken with blows.

I speak for the bush;

You speak for the civilized
Will you hear me?

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UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2020/2021

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF
BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION (ARTS)

ALT 110/ 100: CRITICAL READING AND RESPONSE

DATE: Tuesday, 16th March 2021

TIME: 4.30 p.m. - 6.30 p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer **THREE** questions. Question one is compulsory.

1. Critical reading is a serious process that involves several stages. Discuss these stages with close reference to any texts you have read in this course. (26 marks)
2. Character analysis helps in the understanding of the meanings in a text. Discuss **any two** characters in **any** of the short stories you have read in this course. (22 marks)
3. Discuss how Marjorie Oludhe Macgoye relies on history to craft her story in *Coming to Birth*. (22 marks)
4. Discuss any three themes in John Ruganda's *The Burdens*. (22 marks)
5. Attempt a critical analysis of the following poem. (22 marks)

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Once Upon a Time by Gabriel Okara

Once upon a time, son,
they used to laugh with their hearts
and laugh with their eyes:
but now they only laugh with their teeth,
while their ice-block-cold eyes
search behind my shadow.

There was a time indeed
they used to shake hands with their hearts:
but that's gone, son.
Now they shake hands without hearts
while their left hands search
my empty pockets.

'Feel at home!' 'Come again':
they say, and when I come
again and feel
at home, once, twice,
there will be no thrice-
for then I find doors shut on me.

So I have learned many things, son.
I have learned to wear many faces
like dresses – homeface,
officeface, streetface, hostface,
cocktailface, with all their conforming smiles
like a fixed portrait smile.

And I have learned too
to laugh with only my teeth
and shake hands without my heart.
I have also learned to say, 'Goodbye',
when I mean 'Good-riddance':
to say 'Glad to meet you',
without being glad; and to say 'It's been
nice talking to you', after being bored.

But believe me, son.
I want to be what I used to be
when I was like you. I want
to unlearn all these muting things.
Most of all, I want to relearn
how to laugh, for my laugh in the mirror
shows only my teeth like a snake's bare fangs!

So show me, son,
how to laugh; show me how
I used to laugh and smile
once upon a time when I was like you.

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UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2018/2019

**FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF
BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION (ARTS)**

ALT 100: CRITICAL READING AND RESPONSE

DATE: Monday, 19th November 2018

TIME: 2.00 p.m. - 4.00 p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer question **ONE** and any other **TWO**.

1. Using examples from at least **three** texts studied in this course, explain how critical reading enables the reader to actively engage a literary text. (26 marks)
2. Explain the main steps followed in critical reading of a literary text, making reference to texts studied in the course. (22 marks)
3. Discuss at least **four** thematic concerns presented in Meja Mwangi's *Kill Me Quick* or any other novel studied in this course. (22 marks)
4. a) Discuss stylistic devices used in at least **two** short stories studied in this course. (14 marks)
b) Explain how these stylistic devices have influenced your understanding of the stories' meaning. (8 marks)
5. Critically read the following poem and write an essay on your interpretation. (22 marks)

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The Pauper by Richard Ntiru

Pauper, pauper, craning yours eyes
in all directions, in no direction!
What brutal force, malignant element
dared to forge your piteous fate?
Was it worth the effort, the time?

You limply lean on a leafless tree,
nursing the jiggers that shrivel your bottom,
like a baby newly born to an old woman.
What crime, what treason did you commit,
that you are thus condemned?

And when you trudge on your horny pads,
gullied like the soles of modern shoes,
pads that even jiggers cannot conquer.
Does He admire your sense of endurance
or turn his head away from your impudent presence?

You sit alone on hairless goatskins,
your ribs and bones reflecting the light
that beautiful cars reflect on you,
squashing lice between your nails
and cleaning your nails with dry saliva.

And when He looks at the grimy coating
caking off your emaciated skin,
at the rust that uproots all your teeth,
like a pick on a stony piece of land.
Does He pat his paunch at the wonderful sight?

Pauper, pauper crouching in beautiful verandas
of beautiful cities and beautiful people.
Tourists and I will take you snapshots.
And your MP with a shining head and triple chin
will mourn your fate in a supplementary question at
question time.

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UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2017/2018

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF
BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

ALT 100: CRITICAL READING AND RESPONSE

DATE: Friday, 2nd February 2018

TIME: 8.00 a.m. - 10.00 a.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer **THREE** questions only

Question **ONE** is **COMPULSORY**

1. "Critical reading is more serious than casual reading; it involves our intellectual and emotional engagement with a text, leading to better enjoyment of the text." Referring to any text you have engaged with in the ALT 100 course, demonstrate your understanding of this statement. (26 marks)
2. **Either:**
(a) "In *The Floods*, the struggle between Nankya and Bwogo illuminates the general problems of the post-independent African countries. Discuss. (22 marks)
Or:
(b) It may be argued that "*The Lion And The Jewel*" has no truly heroic character. To what extent do you agree with this statement? (22 marks)
3. With close reference to any short story discussed in this course, show how any two unique elements of style contribute to its central theme. (22 marks)
4. **Either:**
(a) Discuss how Meja Mwangi explores urban problems in *Kill Me Quick*. (22 marks)
Or:
(b) Discuss Achebe's treatment of conflict between the individual and society in "*No Longer At Ease*". (22 marks)

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Page 1 of 2

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL AWITI

5. Read the following poem, and then write a critical essay on it.

(22 marks)

Richard Cory

Whenever Richard Cory went down town
We people on the pavement looked at him:
He was a gentleman from sole to crown,
Clean favored, and imperially slim.

And he was always quietly arrayed,
And he was always human when he talked;
But still he fluttered pulses when he said,
"Good morning," and he glittered when he walked.

And he was rich- yes, richer than a king-
And admirably schooled in every grace:
In fine, we thought that he was everything
To make us wish that we were in his place.

So on we worked, and waited for the light,
And went without the meat, and cursed the bread;
And Richard Cory, one calm summer night,
Went home and put a bullet through his head.

Edwin Arlington Robinson

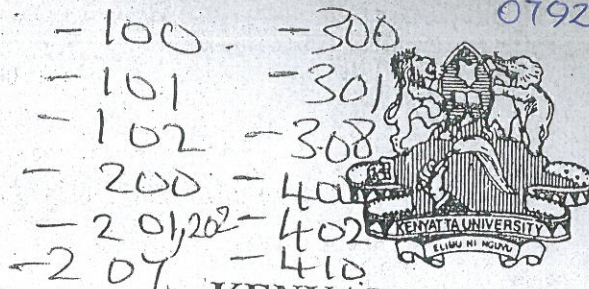
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HOW EXAMS ARE SET
COURTESY OF: RAELO OSEBE
0792746849

- 100, 101
- 202, 200
- 201, 202
- 207, 208
- 300, 301
- 302, 308
- 400, 402
- 410, 417



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UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2013/2014

SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR
OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

ALT 100: CRITICAL READING AND RESPONSE

DATE: Wednesday, 9th April, 2014

TIME: 4.30 p.m. – 6.30 p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer **THREE** questions.

Question **ONE** is Compulsory.

**SIR OTONDE MICHAEL
AWITI**

1. Using examples from texts studied in this course, show how critical reading allows the reader to actively engage a text and become an active constructor of meaning. (26 marks)
2. a) The story "Magic" by Chris Van Wyk suggests that it is virtually impossible to alter human behaviour? Do you agree? (22 marks)
OR
b) With clear illustrations from Mark Mathabane's Kaffir Boy, discuss how the main character was able to persist and rise above the system despite the atrocities and indignities he and his family suffered under apartheid. (22 marks)
3. How is George Orwell's style in "Shooting an Elephant" affected by his attitude to his work, his superiors and to his subordinates? (22 marks)

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Page 1 of 2

4. How far, would you say, does the historical and cultural distance limit your understanding of "The Story of an Hour" by Kate Chopin? (22 marks)

5. Critically assess the following poem: (22 marks)

Beauty

Look not at thyself
Ye that is beautiful
For the many eyes that there are
Will at you candidly stare
Be it an innocent act of will
Or an inadvertent steal of glance
At your captivating beautiful charm

Hate not thyself
Ye that doubteth thy beauty
For in the eyes of the beholder
Indeed lies true beauty
So behold at thyself
And realize how beautiful
Thou truly art

Beauty as it is
Is deep in the skin
But what in the heart is
Defines who we are
Irrespective of our colour

Chrise Ambrose

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